

LED

DO

LIGHT

What does it do?

An LED is a tiny light that your code can switch on, switch off, or blink.

LED stands for light-emitting diode. It glows when electricity flows the right way through it, so the long leg and the short leg matter.

Your projects can use LEDs to show a warning, celebrate something, or tell people what is happening.

Uses



Car brake light

DETECT

Brake pedal pressed



DECIDE

The car is slowing



DO

Light the red LED



One-eyed monster box

DETECT

Box lid is opened



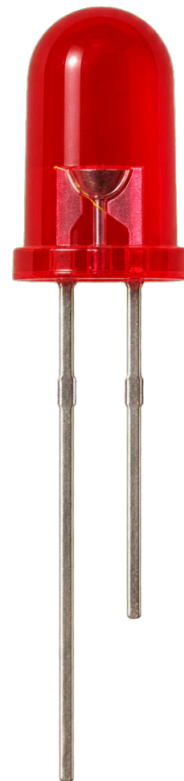
DECIDE

Someone is snooping



DO

Glow the monster eye



Anode

Long leg, to
GPIO

Cathode

Short leg, to
GND

Lens

Glow here

Code

● Raspberry Pi

```
from gpiozero import LED  
  
led = LED(17)  
  
led.on()
```

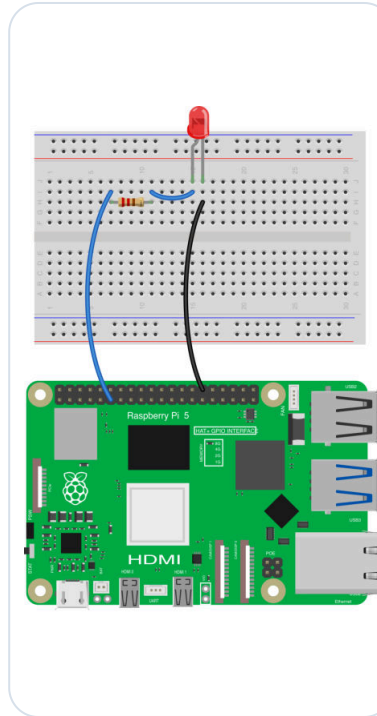
● Raspberry Pi Pico

```
from picozero import LED  
  
led = LED(16)  
  
led.on()
```

Also `led.off()`, `led.toggle()` and `led.blink()`. Give `blink()` an `on_time` and an `off_time` to set the flash speed.

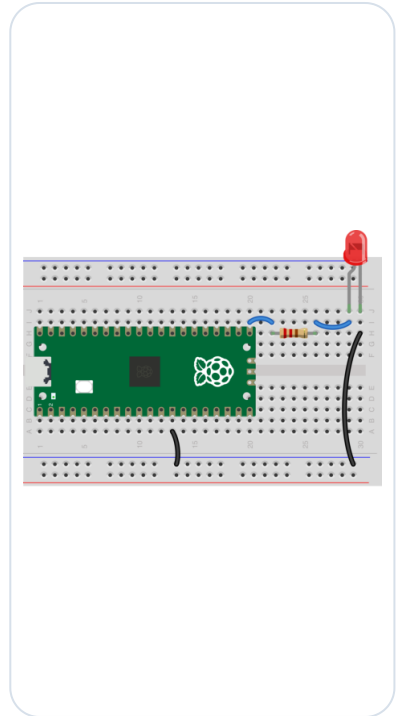
Wiring

RASPBERRY PI 5



GPIO 17 → 220 Ω → LED → GND

PICO



GP16 → 220 Ω → LED → GND